KINKRI DEVI

1925–2007



“I HAVE TO DIE ONE DAY AND IT’S BETTER TO DIE FIGHTING FOR A CAUSE.”

A difficult life

Kinkri Devi was born in Sirmaur district of Himachal Pradesh. Both poverty and caste prejudice prevented Devi from getting an education, and she began working while still a young child. She was married at fourteen but left home to fend for herself when her husband died of typhoid just a few years later. Despite her own troubles, Devi was deeply concerned about the environmental degradation being perpetrated in the Sirmaur region by mining companies. Their reckless and unsustainable quarrying had resulted in land and water pollution and the destruction of the region’s natural beauty.